

1959

FORSAKING HOME

A homeland was lost, perhaps forever. His Potala Palace in Lhasa increasingly under attack, the Dalai Lama crossed into India with 10,000 followers after an abortive Tibetan revolt against the Chinese. India gave him political asylum and here he has stayed since then, heading Tibet's government in exile. Though Jawaharlal Nehru told the Dalai Lama not to look for support in the West where he would look like a "piece of merchandise", independence or nothing was what the Dalai Lama and his people wanted. The Chinese way, he said, would make them a "people without their souls".

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HINDU YA MUSALMAN?

"Tu Hindu banega na musalman banega/Insaan ki aulaad hai insaan banega" (you will not grow up to be a Hindu or a Muslim/you are the son of a man/and a human being you shall be), sang Mohammad Rafi in *Dhool Ka Phool*, directed by Yash Chopra, with lyrics from the great Urdu poet, Sahir Ludhianvi. The movie examined the searing stigma of illegitimacy and carried an impassioned plea for communal harmony.

FIRST CUT

- Bajaj Auto received a Government licence to produce two- and three-wheelers in India.
- The Press Club of India was inaugurated in Delhi.

- National Aerospace Laboratories, India's pre-eminent civil research and development establishment in aeronautics and allied disciplines, was set up in Delhi.

<< DID YOU KNOW

Visiting Peking in 1959, lawyer Daniel Latifi was told by his Chinese colleagues that the "McMohan line (line of control between India and China) had no juridical basis".